

Teacher card

Comparing belief and celebration / GROW_A2_W05

Outcome: Compare how two communities celebrate with an RE link.

Evidence to retain: F: comparison grid and explanation.

Forty minute route

Arrival 4 min; starter 3; model 6; shared task 7; check 2; independent 12; review 3; exit 3.
Pause time is flexible.

Preparation

Choose one independent route. Print the evidence and shared cards, required visual or data sheet, route worksheet and exit. The organiser is one separate A4 page. Keep answers with staff.

Learn about observances without asking anyone to practise a religion. Use unlit objects. Dates and family practices vary.

Access and regulation

Chunk sources and tasks; pre-teach vocabulary with images. Offer sentence stems, organisers, oral rehearsal and typing. Start with one modelled example; extend through a second source, comparison or supported judgement. Check the learner can begin within two minutes, then fade prompts.

Offer a predictable start, private response and agreed pause. No cold calling or forced personal disclosure. Rejoin at one clearly named next step. Keep teen-appropriate examples and the same learning goal across response modes.

Use sensitive content warnings where relevant. Do not ask for family details or personal experiences.

Assessment

Use questioning and the exit response to decide the next step. Record the learner's individual contribution and the access support used.

UAS: no approved unit code is supplied. Match the learner's evidence to the centre-selected unit and exact criteria before submission. This pack makes no automatic award claim.

Model and answers

Read these pages before teaching. Hide the model during independent assessment.

Question: What shared feature can the sources support?

Evidence: D Diwali: Many Hindus mark Diwali with lamps, worship and gatherings. Light can express good overcoming evil and knowledge overcoming ignorance. Practices and stories vary. H Hanukkah: Hanukkah is a Jewish festival lasting eight nights. Lights recall the Temple's rededication and the traditional account of oil lasting eight days. A hanukkiah has eight festival lights and a helper light.

Think aloud: The use of lights.

Check: Does the shared feature make the meanings identical? No. Each account connects light to particular traditions.

Arrival answers

1. No. Communities observe it in several countries.
2. A special period of celebration or remembrance
3. The use of lights.
4. No. Each account connects light to particular traditions.

Shared activity reasoning

1. Use of lights — Both. Both accounts describe lights.
2. Temple rededication — Hanukkah. This meaning is in H.
3. Knowledge overcoming ignorance — Diwali. This interpretation is in D.

Exit responses

What shared feature can the sources support? The use of lights.

Does the shared feature make the meanings identical? No. Each account connects light to particular traditions.

Teaching and evidence record

Supplied scheme of work teaching sequence: Sort features from two celebrations into same/different; explain a similarity or difference while recognising variation within communities.

Look for

F: comparison grid and explanation.

Accept accurate equivalents, including speech or exact scribing. Check the concept and use of evidence rather than length or handwriting. Record access support separately from content prompting.

BUILD: a concrete example with a reason or demonstrated action. GROW: explain or compare with a relevant detail. LAUNCH: connect evidence and reasoning; use a limitation when the outcome requires it. Keep RE responses non-GCSE.

Media

Original captioned teaching model made for this pack. It demonstrates the supplied reasoning; it is not historical footage, survivor testimony or a documentary. The full transcript and factual source credits are included.

Use manual steps for a calm pace. The silent MP4 has visible captions and a matching text transcript. External archive media is optional and should be previewed before class.

Source credits

Hindu American Foundation Diwali <https://www.hinduamerican.org/diwali>

Chabad What is Hanukkah https://www.chabad.org/holidays/chanukah/article_cdo/aid/102911/jewish/What-Is-Hanukkah.htm

Source access was checked on 19 September 2026. Restricted links are listed in Sources_and_checks.html; a restriction here is not proof that the page is dead. Offline teaching material remains available.